

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

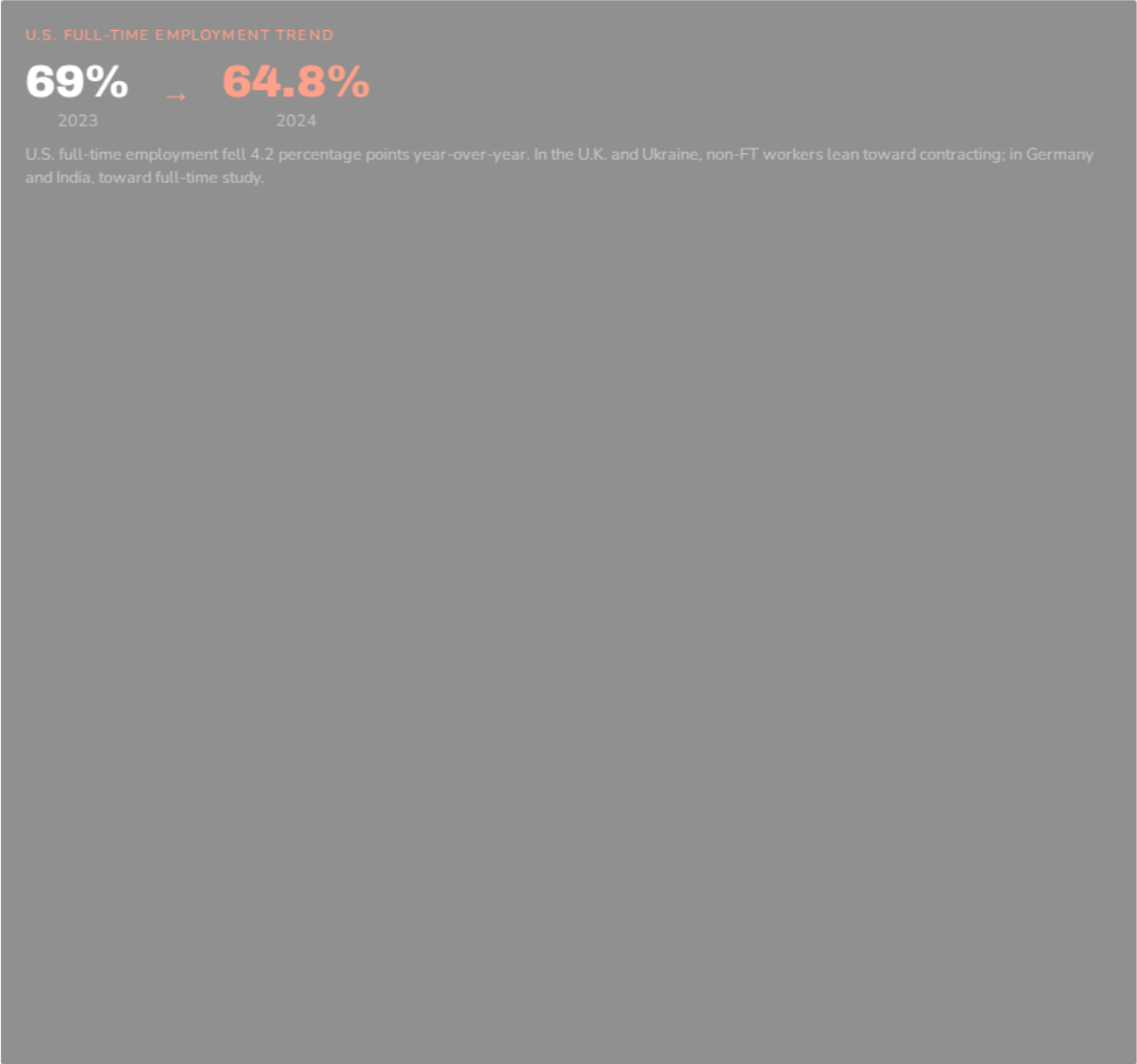
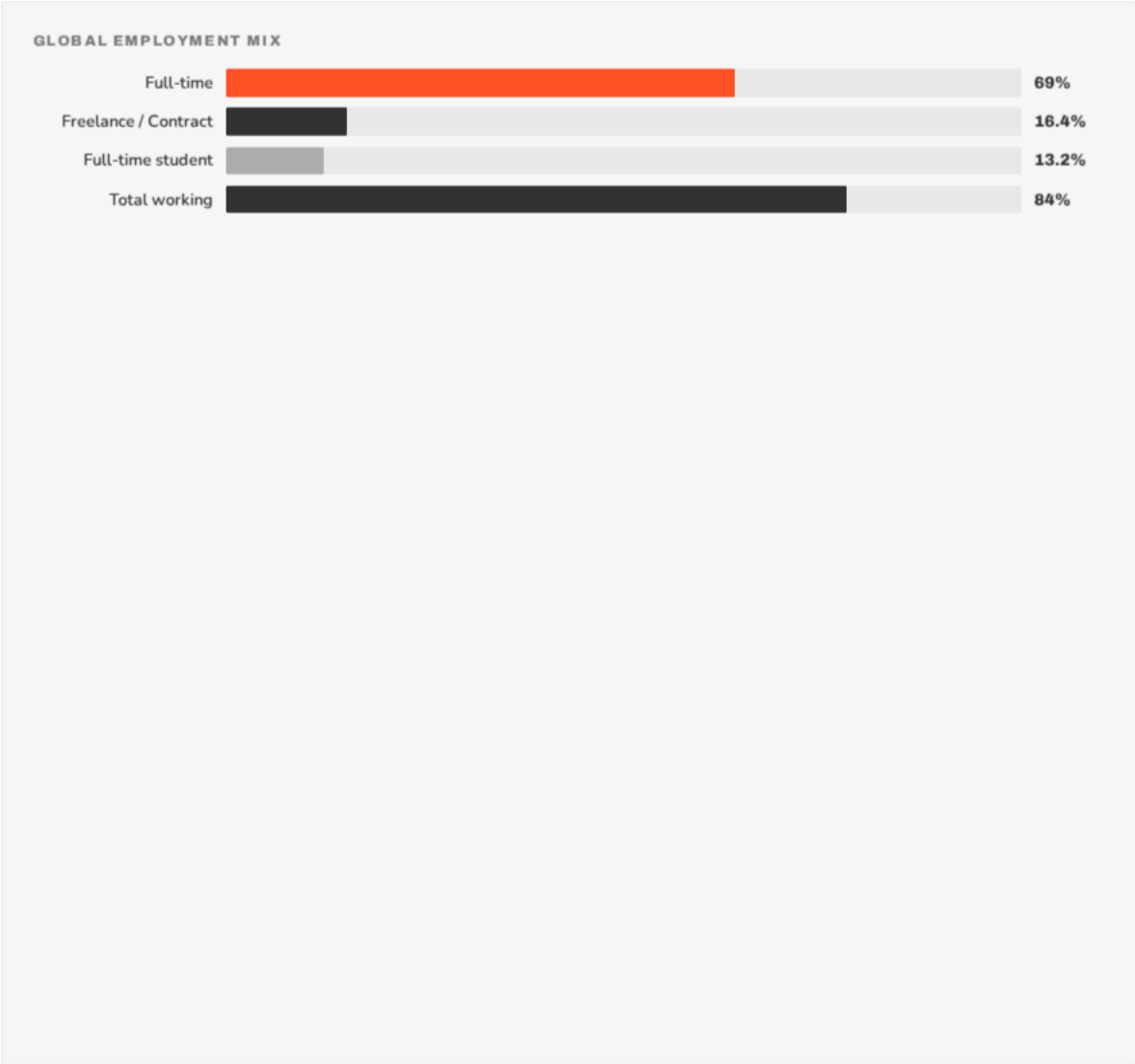
Benchmarking data for engineering managers and HR leaders

65,437
RESPONDENTS

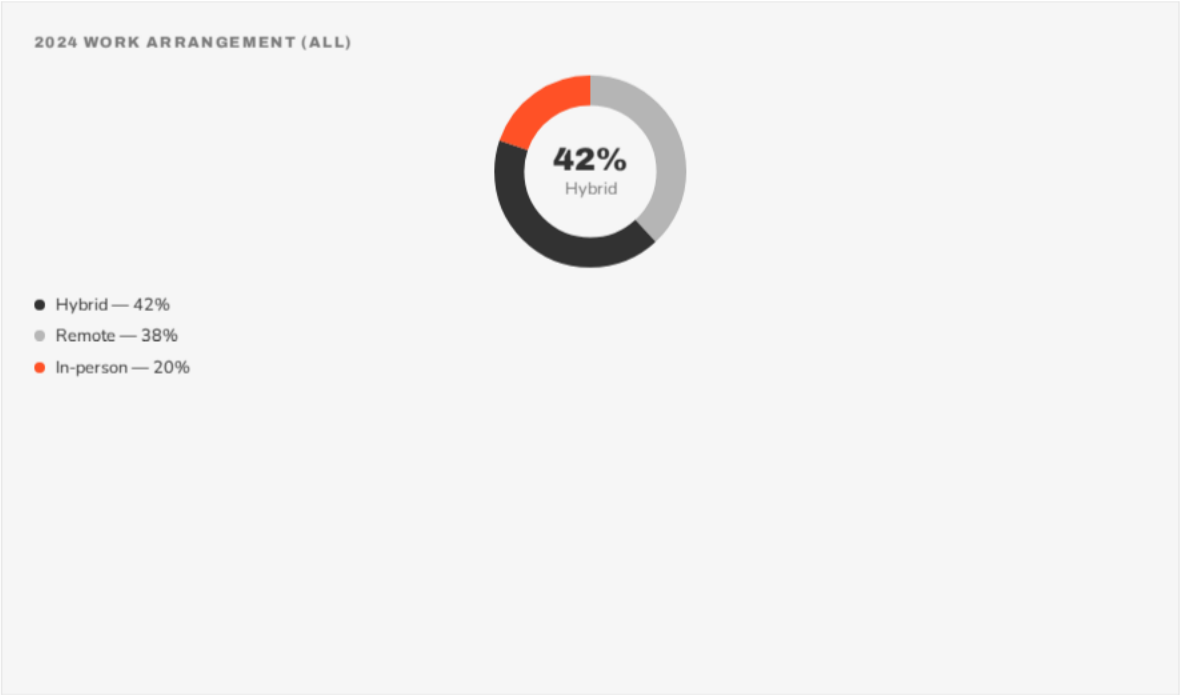
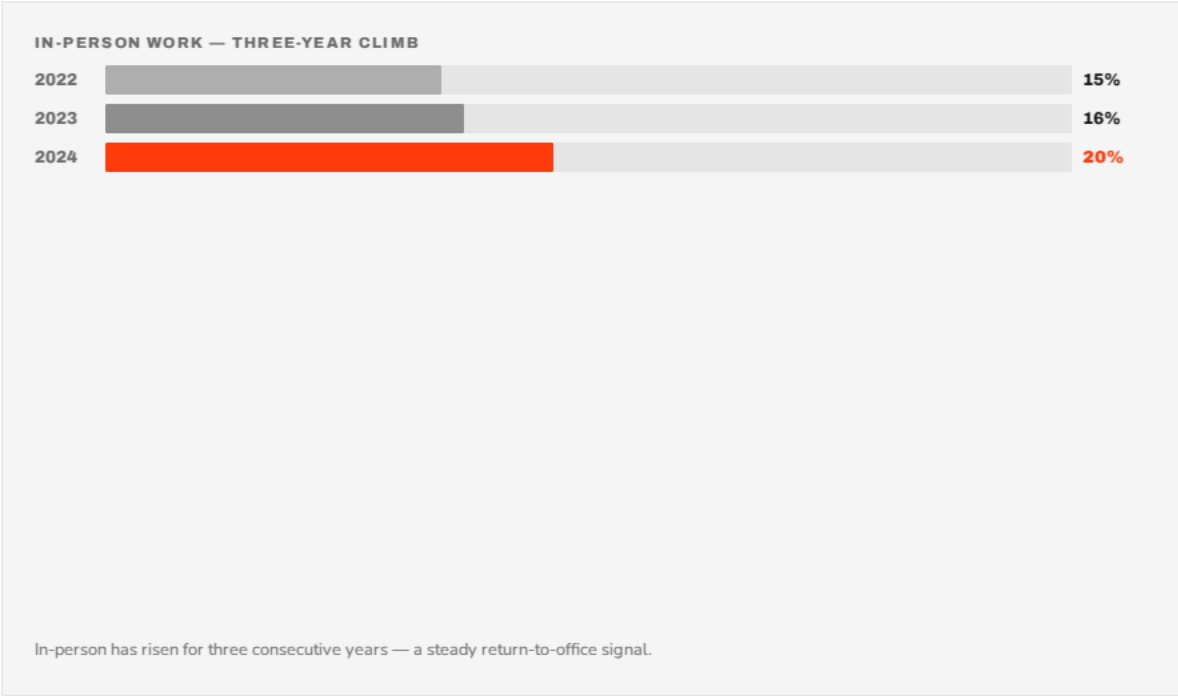
180+
COUNTRIES

2024
SURVEY YEAR

84% of Developers Are Working — but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.



In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

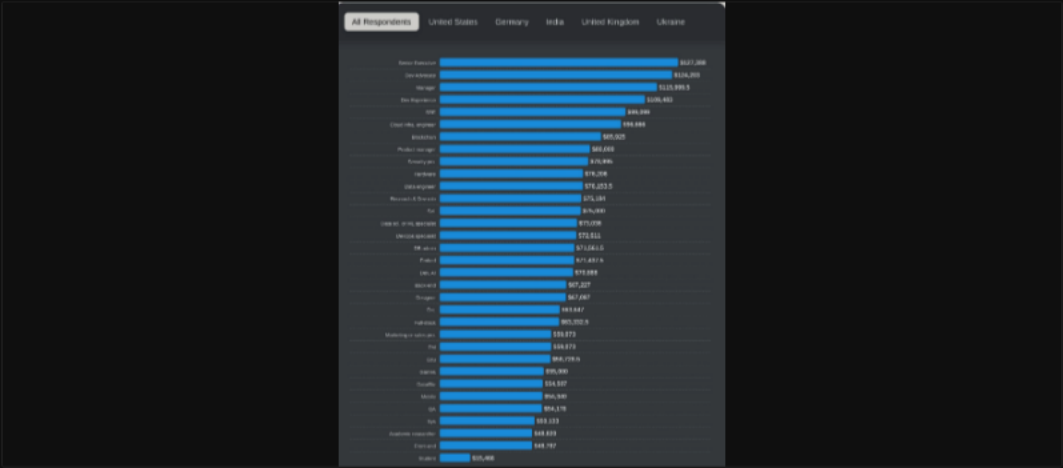


+5pp

In-person work has grown 5 percentage points since 2022 — the largest two-year shift of any work mode. Hybrid (42%) remains dominant and stable.

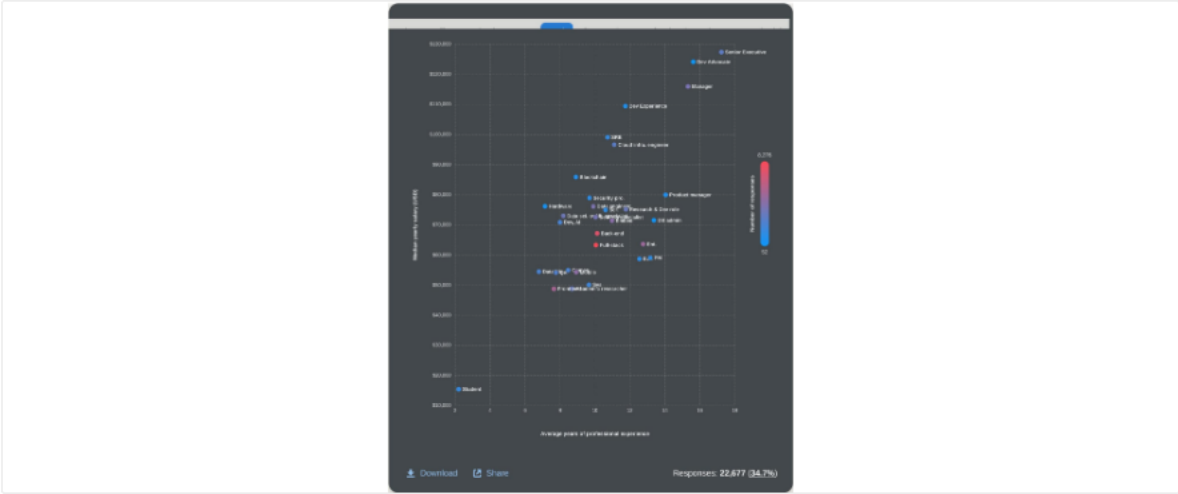
Senior Executives & Dev Advocates

Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Source: 2024 Stack Overflow Survey · 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate) · Median annual compensation in USD

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



~17 yrs • \$127K

Senior Executive — most experienced role, highest median salary

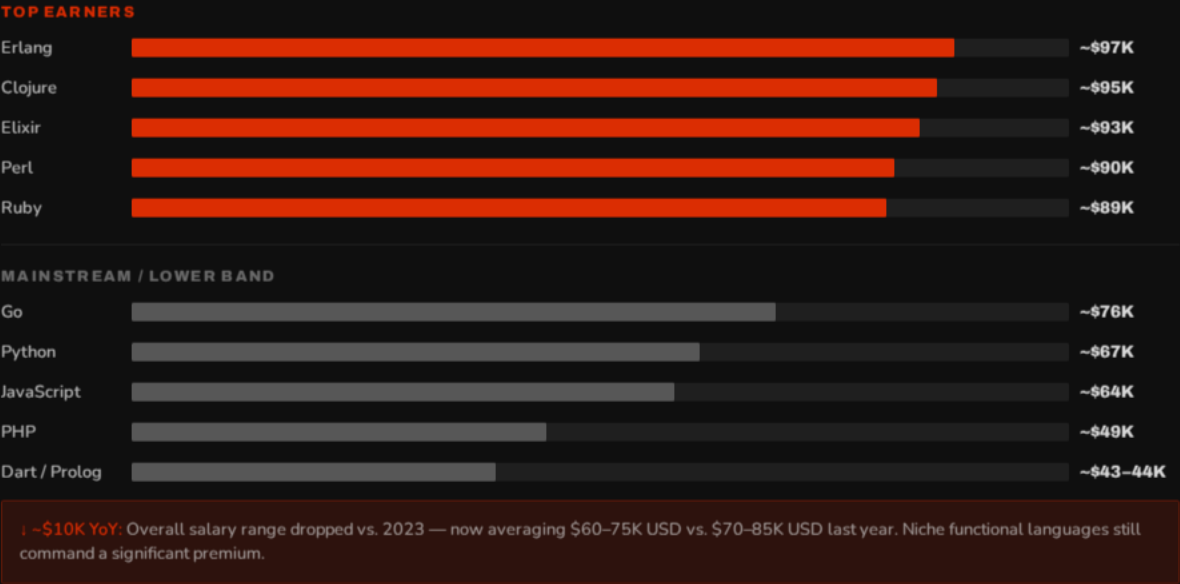
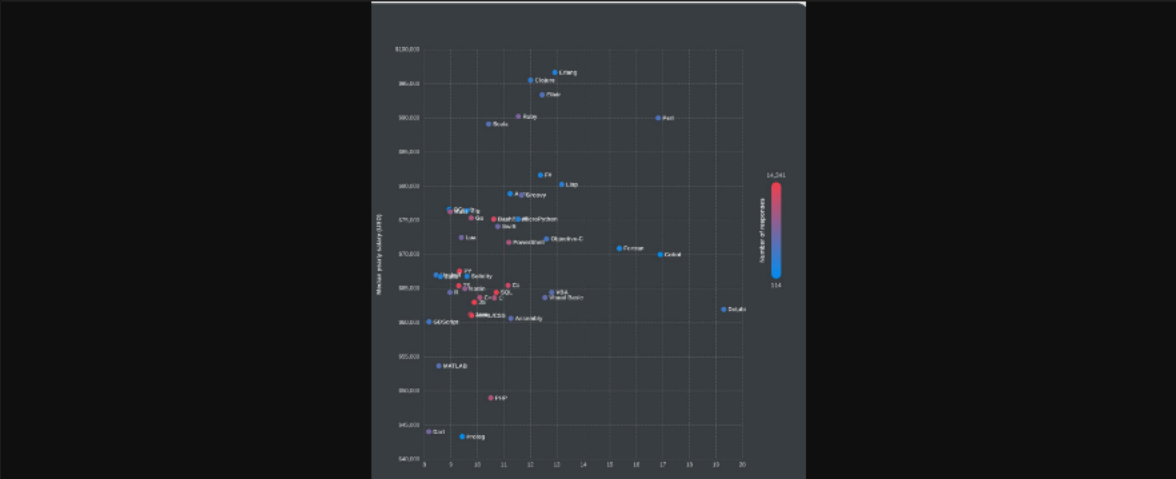
~16 yrs • \$124K

Dev Advocate — experience-driven premium, leadership-tier pay

~10 yrs • \$99K

SRE — highest-paid purely technical role at median experience

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



COMPANY CONTEXT

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs;
62% Influence Tech Purchases

COMPANY SIZE DISTRIBUTION (N=42,827)



47% work at organizations with <100 employees

62%

of developers influence technology purchase decisions at their organization

60%

prefer a build-and-buy approach over purely building or buying

TOP EVALUATION METHODS

75% Start a free trial

73% Ask other developers

Senior Execs (99%), Eng. Managers (87%), and Product Managers (77%) have the highest individual influence.

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

Plan for More Contractors

U.S. full-time employment fell 4pp YoY to 64.8%. Freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+. Workforce planning should include flexible capacity models.

02

Hybrid Still Dominates — In-Person Rising

Hybrid (42%) is stable and dominant, but in-person has grown from 15% → 20% over three years. RTO mandates require careful change management to retain remote-preferring talent.

03

DevRel & SRE Command Premium Pay

Dev Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) command outsized salaries relative to broader engineering roles. Benchmark these roles against leadership-tier comp.

05 Engage Individual Contributors in Vendor Decisions 62% of developers influence tech purchases. Free trials (75%) and peer recommendations (73%) drive evaluation. Vendor and procurement strategies should target ICs, not just management.

